

Contest Mindset and Diagnostic

Persistence Observation Rubric · used during the Entrance Diagnostic

Original Concept Mastery items. Not reproduced from CEMC or any third party.

Score each behaviour 0, 1 or 2 from what you observe during the 60-minute diagnostic. Total out of 12. **This score is recorded separately and never changes the mathematical score.** It informs the placement conversation and the student's first-term goals.

Name		Date		Observer	
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Behaviour	0	1	2	Score
Starts independently	Waits for help or leaves most items untouched for more than 2 minutes.	Starts familiar items; stalls on unfamiliar ones.	Starts every item within about a minute, unprompted.	
Creates a representation	No diagrams, tables or equations on Parts 2-3.	Some representations, incomplete or only when prompted by a method box.	Draws, tabulates or writes an equation on most Part 2-3 items without prompting.	
Tries a second strategy	Stops after the first approach fails.	Repeats the same approach more carefully.	Switches approach when stuck (e.g. from equation to table).	
Uses time deliberately	Spends over 5 minutes on one item, or finishes early with blanks.	Some pacing; returns to few skipped items.	Moves on from stuck items and returns; uses the full hour.	
Checks or revises	No visible checking.	Occasional checking, mostly on easy items.	Visible checks: estimates, substitutes back, re-reads the question.	
Responds constructively to a neutral hint	Disengages or asks for the answer.	Uses the hint partly, then stalls.	Uses the hint to take the next step independently.	
Total (out of 12)				

Neutral-hint protocol

Offer at most one neutral hint per student, only after 3 minutes without progress on one item. A neutral hint contains no mathematics. Use one of: “What is the question asking you to find?” · “What do you know so far?” · “Is there a way to picture this?” Record the item number and the response. Score behaviour 6 from that response; if no hint was needed, score behaviour 6 as ‘not observed’ and total out of 10, noting this on the placement report.

Evidence notes

Item(s)	What you saw